

Epson Stylus TX101

Where it's all about being affordable

Epson has been one of the world's leading manufacturers of inkjet printers, scanners, laser printers and even dot matrix printers. The Epson Stylus TX101 is an all-in-one Printer-Scanner-Copier inkjet and is aimed for home users.

The TX101 is a two flap printer, which means, the paper has to be loaded from the top and comes out from the front. The back flap is almost at a 90° angle which is fine when you are loading a whole lot of paper but is not very useful for loading single sheets.

The buttons are located on the left of this printer with buttons for On/Off, Stop and Copy functionality. Sadly, even though this all-in-one also comes with

a scanner, there is no button for Scan. You need to scan through the PC using the Epson Scan software which comes with the installation CD.

We tested the print quality by printing three test documents. We saw that in economy mode it takes about 10secs to print a document which is light gray in colour and of a bad quality with lines between each word. The same was seen while printing the image & text file which took 40.7secs even in economy mode with the colours not even being clearly visible. In the standard mode, which is normal, the print quality did improve, but the edges were still rough and the time taken for the text documents was at an average of about 27secs.



This Epson is a basic all-in-one printer that does not have anything out of the ordinary going for it. Even though it is priced at only Rs. 3,699, we would not recommend you to buy this as quality wise it is not ideal.

Specifications

Maximum resolution: 5760x1440 dpi , Optical resolution: 600 X 1200 DPI, 48 bits input, 24 bits output

Contact: Epson India
Phone: 080 30515000
E-mail: think@eid.epson.co.in
Web site: www.epson.co.in
Price: Rs. 3,699

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

The image quality was an improvement, but that page took 127.1secs with the same jagged edges around text.

We also tested photo printing by printing a full page colour test document on some photo paper. The quality was slightly dull with some pixilation in comparison to the actual image. The time taken to print this at the best quality was 9 mins and 28 secs which is just too long for one print.

LG KP500 Cookie

No cookie for me

The Cookie is a clean looking phone at first glance. Its got a really uncluttered front facia with just three, small and well beveled buttons. The phone itself is finished in matte black and has a steel-grey ring running right around the sides that adds a classy look. The camera and phone screen lock buttons are on one side and very easy to use despite their small size owing to great feedback, the volume up/down buttons aren't as good. LG has added the ability to finger swipe through albums and this is called "Free Touch", an obvious rip-off from Apple's Multi Touch; but it doesn't work anywhere at all as well which is why there's a stylus provided. Its light years away from the

flawless fluidity of Apple's touch interface. Add to that a very slow processor which becomes amply evident as you use the touch feature when browsing albums and such. We were a bit disappointed with the touch sensitivity. On a more positive note touch accuracy is a bit better and acceptable for a phone in this bracket.

The screen itself is quite large and clear although we've seen better screens in

the Xperia and the iPhone. The Cookie does make a strong point for itself by having a well laid out menu system with pretty good icons – not like some of the cartoonish icons we've seen from LG in the past. LG provides a neat bunch of games and quite frankly we had a bit of fun playing these.

This is no camera phone and we've seen much better and there's no flash. MP3 playback quality is strictly so-so and another pain is LGs continued use of a proprietary connect for the same rather than a 3.5mm jack. Call quality and signal reception strength on the Cookie isn't all that great and nowhere close to Nokia phones.

Priced at Rs 13,500 its a mixed bundle. Although not many phones can offer such a large touchscreen for the price there are other prob-

lems that prevent us from recommending you swallow this Cookie (pardon the pun!). For one, it's a mediocre phone, MP3 playback quality and the camer could be better. There are other alternatives for this price range that do far more as a phone and as multimedia devices.

Specifications

Specifications: Screen – 3.0", 240 x 400 pixels, 3 MP camera, microSD expansion, 89 grams

Contact: LG Electronics India Pvt. Ltd
Phone: 91-120-2560900
E-mail: VivekSingh@lgindia.com
Web site: www.lgindia.com
Price: Rs. 13,500

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★



XFX 9800GT

The affordable performer

NVIDIA's 9 series graphic cards are nothing more than a refurbished GeForce 8 series card. The main difference is that the 9800GT uses 65nm GPU unlike its 8800GT counterpart. The XFX version of this card looks really great. Firstly it does not take up two PCI slots as the others that share the same numerical part of the name; 9800GTX, 9800GX2, 9800GTX+. XFX has used its own cooling solution which is a plus point. Other than looks, this card has 112 SPs and comes at stock clocks of 600 MHz for the core and 512 MB of GDDR3 memory clocked at 1800 MHz.

There is no game bundled with this card, nor is there any overclocking software. But XFX never provides overclocking software anyways. When it comes to per-



formance you cannot expect this to be as good as a GTX 280, but it did very well for a mid-range card. We ran it through a series of benchmarks at different settings for various games are the results are as such. In Crysis at 1280x1024 with 4xAA and 4xAF we got 33 fps and at 1920x1200 with 4xAA and 4xAF we got 16 fps. In Stalker: Shadow of Chernobyl, 125.53 fps was seen at 1280x1024 with 4x AA and 4x AF whereas, 78 fps was seen at 1920x1200 with 4x AA and 4x AF. With settings of 1280x1024 and 1920x1200 with 4x AA and 8x AF for Unreal Tournament

3, we got the results of 146 fps and 77 fps respectively.

On the other side, we also tested games that were not as demanding (graphic wise) but are all time favourites too like Doom 3, Prey and Far Cry. In Doom 3 with the settings of 4x AA at 1600x1200 we got 93.5 fps. With prey at 1280x1024 (4x AA, 4x AF) we got 112.2 fps and at 1920x1200 (4x AA, 4x AF) it was 70.6 fps. FarCry results were also very good, 1280x1024 (4x AA, 8x AF) - 147.15 fps and at 1920x1200 (4x AA, 8x AF) - 102.33 fps.

The XFX 9800GT gave a 3D Mark 06 score of 13351,

Intex IT-5400FM

Average performer at a cheap price

Intex's IT-5400 FM are a 5.1 speaker set that can be used with both the PC and also in your living room with your TV. The satellites of this set are of the same large size. Build quality of the woofer is good but the satellites have a thin mesh behind a cloth which isn't very strong. The design of the speakers themself lack style and seem kind-of boring. The design of the remote also looks outdated. Batteries don't fit well into the remote.

The speakers come with a FM tuner which works fairly alright and picked up reception instantaneously when we first put it on without connecting it to our PC. The woofer has a

small display on it that displays information of the volume. Performing tasks like changing volume requires you to keep pressing the volume up and down buttons constantly. The buttons on the woofer are also of poor quality.

The quality of the speakers is average. One of the major complaints like with most of the other Intex speakers we've received is the colouring of the sound. The sound is more emphasised towards

the higher mids. The sound is pretty warm but it lacks detail. There is crystal clear crisp highs that come out from the speakers. The flappy smooth harmonic bass isn't present either but the the beats are pretty distinct.

If there's one strong point, it's that the 5400FM's do not distort at high volumes in music and movies. The frequency sweep test did cause a tiny bit of distortion. In general, listening to these speakers isn't so much fun. Watching movies is fine but music isn't as much fun with these speakers.

Connections to the speaker are made through



which is good for this card. The XFX 9800GT is good card to use for games at a low resolution. It will give you good results up to a resolution of 1280x1024 with high detail. If you are planning to go above that with a shiny 22-inch LCD or something then expect the performance to fall.

Specifications

Core Clock - 600 MHz, Memory Clock - 1800 MHz, Memory - 512MB GDDR3 Stream Processors - 112, 512 MB GDDR3, Memory Interface - 256 bit

Contact: Hewlett Packard
Phone: 124 - 2566 111
Email: seema.dawar@hp.com
Web site: www.hp.com/in
Price: Rs. 8,800

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

RCA connectors so you need 3.5mm jack to RCA connectors to connect to these speakers.

These speakers are clearly best used with a DVD player or an HTPC and connected to a TV. At Rs 3,950, they are a decent pair of speakers and one of the cheapest 5.1 speakers you'll come across.

Contact: Intex Technologies
Phone: 09811037376
E-mail: info@intextechnologies.com
Web site: www.intextechnologies.com
Price: Rs 3,950

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★